a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

GRADE 8 · STUDENT ACTIVITY BOOK

Workbook for the Year

Activities, sort tasks, and reflection prompts you'll keep.

Year theme: Measure, Improve, Operate Smarter

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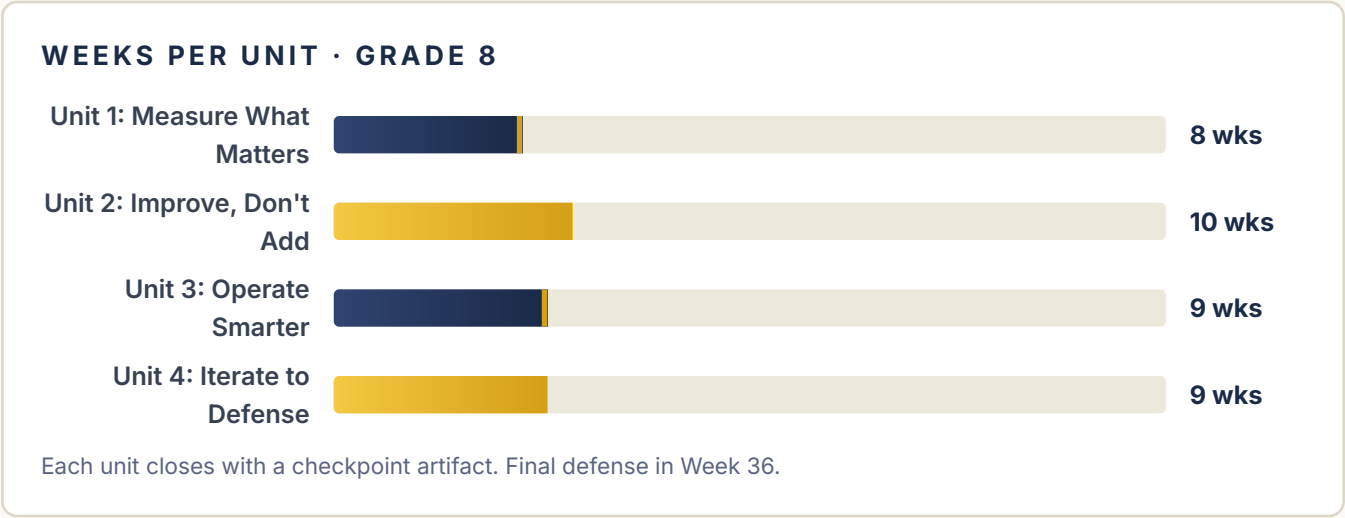
YEAR-AT-A-GLANCE

Four Units. Thirty-Six Weeks. One Capstone.

The year is built as four units, each ending with a public-facing artifact that feeds the rolling Capstone. The bars show how the weeks are spent — roughly equal, with a slight lean toward the math-heavy unit because per-customer math is the load-bearing skill.



36 WEEKS

4 UNITS

10 LESSONS

8 CASH VIDEOS

GRADE 8 · STUDENT ACTIVITY BOOK

Workbook for the Year

A little less wrong, every week.

Welcome back.

If you took Grade 7 last year, you already know the deal: this is the place to do the work that turns big ideas into real things you've made. You'll fill it in, mess it up, scratch things out, and revise. That's the point.

If you're new to Cash to Company, here's the short version: this book has activities, charts, and reflection prompts. You'll keep a Capstone Journal (a separate notebook) for your messy thinking. This book is the structured part. The journal is the messy part. You need both.

This year, Cash, your animated guide, asks you to graduate from "knowing your customer" to "running tests on your venture." The question Cash kept asking last year still applies — **which people, and how do you know?** — but now you'll add a second one: **what's your bet, and what would tell you you're wrong?**

How to use this book

"Which people, and how do you know?"

— CASH

- **Date every entry.** Future-you will care.
- **Quote your evidence.** A made-up customer quote isn't evidence; a real one is.
- **Compute, don't guess.** When the activity asks for a number, do the math.
- **Variance is data.** When your plan and your reality disagree, write the gap. Don't hide it.
- **It's okay to be wrong.** The whole point of running a test is to find out what's wrong, faster.

Unit 1 — From idea to test

Activity 1.1 — Day 1 Improvement Bet

Fill in this sentence about your imagined Capstone venture:

"If I changed _____ in my venture, I think _____ would move by _____ because _____."

One thing I'm least sure about in this bet:

Predict: In Week 18, will the data say you were:

1	2	3	4
Right	Partly right	Wrong	Moved for a reason I didn't predict

Circle one.

Activity 1.2 — SCAMPER on Your Capstone

Pick a problem your venture is trying to solve. State it here:

Problem: _____

Apply SCAMPER. Write at least one idea per prompt.

Letter	Prompt	Idea
S	Substitute — what could I swap out?	
C	Combine — what could I merge with something?	
A	Adapt — what could I borrow from elsewhere?	
M	Modify — what could I make bigger, smaller, different?	
P	Put to other use — how else could this be used?	
E	Eliminate — what could I remove?	
R	Reverse — what could I flip or rearrange?	

Two ideas that surprised me:

A. _____

B. _____

Activity 1.3 — Three "How Might We" Statements

Write 3 HMWs for your Capstone. Use the full format every time:

"How might we **__ for _ so that ___**?"

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Self-check: Read each HMW to a partner. The partner should be able to think of at least 3 ideas in response. If they can't, your HMW is too narrow. Revise.

Activity 1.4 — Value Lever Spotter

For the In-N-Out vs. McDonald's case (or another case provided by your teacher), fill in the three columns with at least 2 specific examples each:

(the food itself)	(cost structure or price)	(how the customer feels)

The lever they pulled hardest: _____

Evidence (one quote or fact from the case): _____

Now: which lever is YOUR Capstone pulling hardest? _____

Which is your weakest? _____

Activity 1.5 — The Ideation Pack (Checkpoint 1)

This pack feeds your Week 8 Checkpoint. Build it in your Capstone Journal using these 4 pages.

Page 1: Problem statement.

"_____ struggles with _____ when _____, because _____."

Page 2: 10 ideas. (Pull from SCAMPER and HMW work.)

#	Idea
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	
6	
7	

#	Idea
8	
9	
10	

Page 3: Score each idea against 3 criteria. Pick your 3 criteria first.

My 3 criteria are: 1) __ **2)** __ 3) ____

Score each idea 1–3 on each criterion. Top 3 ideas are the finalists.

Page 4: The 1 selected.

The selected idea is: _____

I picked it over the other 2 finalists because: _____

The first test I could run on it: _____

Unit 1 Reflection

In your Capstone Journal, answer:

1. Did SCAMPER push me past my obvious ideas? Where?
2. What's a finalist I rejected that I might come back to?
3. What value lever am I pulling, and what would have to be true to switch it?

Unit 2 — The break-even truth

"Most adults skip this. You won't."

— CASH

Activity 2.1 — Linear-Equation Break-Even Setup

For your Capstone, fill in:

Input	Value
Price per unit	$_
Variable cost per unit	$_
Fixed cost per month	$_
Contribution margin per unit (price – VC)	$_

The break-even equation:

Total revenue = Total cost

$_ × n = $_ + $_ × n

Solve for n (units to break even):

n = _____ units per month

Sanity check: $_ ÷ $_ (CM per unit) = _____ units. Same? Yes / No

Activity 2.2 — Two Sample Businesses

Try the formula on two sample ventures.

Sample 1 — Friendship-bracelet shop

- Price: $5. Variable cost: $2. Fixed cost: $30/month.
- Equation: $5n = $30 + $2n
- Solve: n = _____ bracelets/month.

Sample 2 — Tutoring service

- Price: $20/session. Variable cost: $2/session. Fixed cost: $40/month.
- Equation: _____
- Solve: n = _____ sessions/month.

Activity 2.3 — Sensitivity Table

Build a 2-scenario sensitivity table for your Capstone.

	Worst case	Best guess	Best case
Price per unit	$_____	$_____	$_____
Variable cost per unit	$_____	$_____	$_____

	Worst case	Best guess	Best case
Fixed cost per month	$_____	$_____	$_____
Contribution margin per unit	$_____	$_____	$_____
Break-even units per month	_____	_____	_____

Reason for worst-case numbers (1 sentence):

Reason for best-case numbers (1 sentence):

My most-sensitive input is: _____

If it moves badly, I would: _____

Activity 2.4 — Break-Even Reasonableness Check

Look at your break-even number from 2.1.

To hit it monthly, I need _ customers per week. (Divide BE by 4.)

Is this realistic? Circle one: Yes / Tight / No way

My evidence (from interviews, observations, prior Grade 7 work):

If "No way," what's a realistic adjustment? Change which input?

Activity 2.5 — Break-Even Memo (Checkpoint 2)

Write this 1-page memo in your Capstone Journal.

To: Cash (and your future self) **From:** [Your name] **Date:** _____ **Subject:** Break-even analysis for [your venture]

1. **My venture and the math.** (1–2 sentences. Name the price, VC, fixed cost.)
2. **My break-even.** (1 sentence with the number.)
3. **Sensitivity.** (3–4 sentences: best-case BE, worst-case BE, most-sensitive input.)
4. **What would have to be true for me to be wrong about the math.** (2–3 sentences.)

Unit 2 Reflection

In your Capstone Journal:

1. Did the math change my mind about the venture?
2. Where am I least sure about my numbers?
3. If I had to bring break-even down by 30%, where would I cut?

Unit 3 — Marketing as experiment

Activity 3.1 — A/B Test Hypothesis

Pick the variable you'll test. **Only one variable changes.** Same product, same audience, same length, same colors — only the words change.

	Message A	Message B
Headline		
Body (1 sentence)		

My hypothesis: Message _ **will win because** _____

Predicted lift (vote difference or %): _____

One bias my test cannot eliminate: _____

The metric I'll count: _____

Where I'll run the test: _____

Activity 3.2 — A/B Test Tally

Day	Message A votes	Message B votes
1		
2		
3		
Total		

Winner: ___

Lift formula: (winner − loser) ÷ loser × 100 = _____ %

Verdict (circle one): A wins / B wins / Inconclusive

Activity 3.3 — Honest Analysis

Two-sentence rule:

Sentence 1: Message **_ won by** ___ %.

Sentence 2: My test cannot tell me whether _____ _____.

Activity 3.4 — First PDSA Cycle on Your Marketing

Fill in all four boxes.

What change am I making? Metric? Target?

When and how I'll run the test (3-day window).

After the run, what did the metric show? Lift?

Adopt? Try again with a different change? Kill?

Activity 3.5 — Marketing Test Memo (Checkpoint 3)

Write this 1-page memo in your Capstone Journal.

1. **What I tested.** (1–2 sentences.)
2. **What I found.** (Lift number, verdict.)
3. **What my test cannot tell me.** (1–2 sentences.)
4. **My PDSA cycle.** (Plan, Do, Study, Act — one sentence each.)
5. **My final message after the cycle.** (1 sentence.)

Unit 3 Reflection

In your Capstone Journal:

1. Was I tempted to fudge the count? Why?
2. What does it feel like to call a test inconclusive?
3. If a customer told me my message was confusing, what would I change first?

Unit 4 — Operate smarter

"A little less wrong, every week."

— CASH

Activity 4.1 — 4-Week Project Plan

Build your plan. List 5–8 milestones across the 4 weeks.

Milestone	Owner	Deadline (Week + day)

Activity 4.2 — Variance Tracker

After Weeks 29–30, fill in the actuals.

Milestone	Plan	Actual	Variance	Reason

My biggest variance was: _____

Type (circle): Schedule / Scope / Quality

Activity 4.3 — Variance Explanation (1 page in Capstone Journal)

Use this structure:

1. **Claim.** "My biggest variance was **_, caused by ___**."
2. **Evidence.** (The numbers from 4.2.)
3. **Reasoning.** Two contributing factors.
4. **Next move.** What changes in the remaining 2 weeks of the sprint.

Activity 4.4 — Peer Feedback Round (Both Directions)

Pair with one classmate. Run the feedback round. Both of you fill in **both columns**.

Question	About my partner's Capstone	About mine (from partner)
What's working?		
What's confusing?		
One change I'd try		

Reflection: What did I learn from giving feedback that I didn't from getting it?

Activity 4.5 — Privacy and Safety Risk Plan

For your venture (especially if it's online), name and mitigate.

Privacy risk: _____

3-step mitigation plan:

1.
2.
3.

Safety risk: _____

3-step mitigation plan:

1.
2.
3.

One platform / age requirement I checked: _____

Activity 4.6 — Final PDSA Cycle

This is the year's culminating PDSA. Pick one part of your venture you ran a full cycle on.

The change, the metric, the target.

When and how you ran it.

What the data showed. (Specific number.)

Adopt / iterate / kill. With reason.

The next test (Cycle 2 — preview Grade 9):

Unit 4 Reflection

In your Capstone Journal:

1. What was the hardest peer feedback to hear?
2. What's a privacy or safety risk I almost missed?
3. If I were running this venture for real for another month, what's the first PDSA cycle I'd run?

Capstone Defense Prep

Activity 5.1 — The Five-Minute Defense Outline

You have 5 minutes. Plan it out, one minute per section.

Minute 1: The idea. Selected via SCAMPER + HMW. Why this one over the finalists? - _____

Minute 2: The math. Break-even, sensitivity, most-sensitive input. - _____

Minute 3: The message. A/B test results, lift, honest analysis. - _____

Minute 4: The plan + variance. What I planned, what I delivered, the gap, the PDSA cycle. - _____

Minute 5: The risk + me. Privacy + safety mitigation. The biggest thing I learned about myself. - _____

Activity 5.2 — Two Likely Panel Questions (Pre-Game)

Predict 2 panel questions and draft a 2–3 sentence answer for each.

Predicted question 1: _____

My answer: _____

Predicted question 2: _____

My answer: _____

Activity 5.3 — Year-End Reflection

The biggest thing I learned this year was:

The PDSA cycle taught me:

One thing I'd tell next year's Grade 8 student:

I'm proud of:

I'm going to keep working on:

A short note from Cash

"Listening is not a moment. It's a system."

— CASH

Hey — Cash here.

Last year, you learned that a customer is a specific person before they're a number. This year, you learned to put numbers around them — break-even, lift, variance, contribution margin — and to run small honest tests instead of big confident guesses.

Most adults skip both years. They start a venture without knowing the customer, and they run it without measuring the variance. You won't. You'll know what each customer contributes. You'll know what your message actually does. You'll know where your plan disagreed with reality. And when you start the next thing — Grade 9, or a real venture, or a club, or a project at work years from now — you'll know how to ask: which people, and how do you know? what's the bet, and what would tell you you're wrong?

You probably didn't make money this year. That's still the win. You did the work. See you in Grade 9 — where you build the canvas.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Deliberate practice (Grade 8)

Practice A — Three break-even scenarios

For your Capstone (or hypothetical):

Scenario A: Price = $**, Variable cost = $**, Fixed cost = $**/month. Contribution margin = $**. Break-even = ___ units/month.

Scenario B (price drops 20%): Recompute. Break-even = ___.

Scenario C (variable cost drops 20%): Recompute. Break-even = ___.

Which change reduced break-even more — the price drop or the cost drop? ____

Practice B — One PDSA cycle, fully filled

Pick one piece of your Capstone you want to improve.

Plan. What change will you try? ____ **What metric will tell you it worked? _____**

Do. What did you actually do? _____

Study. What was the result? ____ **Did the metric move? By how much? _____**

Act. Based on this, what do you do next? Keep, change, kill? _____

Practice C — A/B test reading

Imagine your A/B test gave these results:

Test	Message A	Message B
Day 1	12 picks	8 picks
Day 2	10 picks	11 picks
Day 3	14 picks	9 picks
Total	**36**	**28**

Total: 64 votes. A wins by 12.5%. Is this signal or noise?

Your verdict: _____

What would you do next? _____

Practice D — Privacy and safety risk plan

For your Capstone:

Risk type	What's the risk for me?	3-step mitigation
Privacy		1. ___ 2. ___ 3. ___
Safety		1. ___ 2. ___ 3. ___

ABOUT THE HOST

Cash, in five words

curious · warm · honest · patient · specific

"I'm Cash. I don't promise wealth. I don't promise success. I promise that the moves — interview, math, message, listen — will make you a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."

— CASH

What Cash does

- **Asks questions that point to evidence.** Cash never tells; Cash asks what your evidence says.
- **Names rules sparingly.** "An assumption is something you think is true without checking. Evidence is something you observed, heard, or counted."
- **Tells short, made-up-but-realistic stories.** 30–60 seconds, shows don't tell.
- **Celebrates the move, not the win.** Revision, honesty, and evidence — not revenue.
- **Hedges deliberately.** probably, often, sometimes — never absolutes about complex topics.

What Cash never does

- Flatter ("amazing!", "great job!"), promise wealth, moralize about money.
- Reference real brands or living celebrities as endorsements.
- Surface family financial details. (Hypothetical scenarios only.)
- Pretend the world is fair. Cash is honest about systemic factors without becoming a politics class.

> *When in doubt, work one of these into the script: Which people, and how do you know? · Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal. · Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. · A little less wrong, every week.*

STRAND OUTCOMES

Eight Strands. One Year. Verifiable Outcomes.

Cash to Company runs the same eight strands K-12. Each year deepens the demonstration. The Grade 8 version of each strand is below.

Code	Strand	Grade 8 demonstrated outcome
BAVC	Business Awareness and Value Creation	Identify a business problem, propose a value-creation hypothesis, and revise it with customer evidence.
PSIG	Problem Solving and Idea Generation	Generate, screen, and refine ideas; document why one was chosen and the others were not.
MFL	Money and Financial Literacy	Compute revenue, variable cost, contribution margin, and breakeven for a real product or service.
CBM	Customers, Branding, Marketing	Build a persona from interview evidence; design honest messaging; A/B test two claims.
OSO	Operations, Systems, Organization	Design a simple weekly operating cadence with named roles, handoffs, and a feedback loop.
LTO	Leadership, Teamwork, Ownership	Run and document a team meeting; resolve one disagreement using shared evidence.
ESL	Ethics, Safety, Legal Awareness	Identify the line between persuasion and manipulation; flag one borderline claim and rewrite it honestly.
LRCI	Launch Readiness and Continuous Improvement	Pilot, measure, and document at least three iterations with rationale and what changed.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

Six Benchmarks This Year

Standards are cited at the benchmark level. Honest gaps are named when they exist.
The Capstone artifact addresses each one.

Benchmark	What students must demonstrate
Jump$tart 6 (Financial Decision Making) 8-1	Identify the components of decision-making and apply them to financial decisions.
CCSS-Math 8.SP.A.1	Construct and interpret scatter plots for bivariate measurement data.
CCSS-ELA SL.8.4	Present claims and findings, emphasizing salient points in a focused, coherent manner.
C3 D2.Eco.5.6-8	Explain ways in which money facilitates exchange.
CASEL Responsible Decision-Making	Demonstrate curiosity and open-mindedness; analyze information.
CCSS-Math 7.RP.A.3	Use proportional relationships to solve multistep ratio and percent problems.

HOW TO READ THIS TABLE

Each lesson cites at least one of these benchmarks. Each Capstone checkpoint addresses two or more. The Teacher Guide includes a per-lesson standards crosswalk.

"Standards aren't a cage. They're a list of moves you're going to be glad you can make. Pick one. Practice it. Move on."

— CASH

CAPSTONE RUBRIC (4-POINT)

How We Score the Capstone

The Capstone artifact is scored on four traits, each on a 4-point scale. Honest, specific, decision-oriented work earns the high marks. Generic or assumption-laden work earns the low ones.

Trait	1 — Emerging	2 — Developing	3 — Proficient	4 — Advanced
Evidence quality	Mostly assumptions; few or no quotes.	2-3 interview quotes; partial evidence.	5+ direct quotes; varied sources; coded patterns.	Triangulated quotes plus behavioral observation; counter-evidence acknowledged.
Per-customer math	Confused costs; no contribution margin.	CM computed but with errors; one price scenario.	Correct CM and breakeven; clear pricing rationale.	CM under multiple price scenarios; LTV-lite reasoning.
Honest messaging	Vague or misleading claims.	Some specifics; some unsupported claims.	All claims supported; clean ethics check.	A/B-tested copy with rationale; resists clever-but-borderline phrasing.
Feedback system	One-time check; no documentation.	Ad-hoc feedback; partial revisions.	1-week feedback loop with 3 documented changes.	Sustained loop plus signal-vs-noise analysis plus revision log.

CALIBRATION NOTE

Score honestly. A "3" means the student met the standard the way an adult professional would. A "4" means they did something a working entrepreneur would be proud to show. Withhold "4" unless the work earns it.

SENSITIVITY AND FAMILY ENGAGEMENT

What We Don't Ask. What We Always Frame.

Money is a tool, not a virtue. Some students live in households with credit-card debt, low or no banking access, or active financial stress. The curriculum is built so that none of those students is asked to disclose, perform, or apologize for their family situation.

Rules of the room

- **Never ask about family money.** No questions about parents income, debts, accounts, or banking status.
- **Use neutral hypotheticals.** "For a sample family with a $4,000/month take-home" — not "your family."
- **Decouple wealth from worth.** Cash never says "everyone can be rich." Cash says "you will be a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."
- **Name systemic factors honestly.** Wage gaps, geography, and luck shape outcomes. The skill we build is the skill in the student hands.
- **Protect the venture.** A student Capstone is theirs. We don't require they share revenue or family contribution. The artifact is the work, not the bank account.

Family engagement

Parents get one well-framed question per quarter — never a quiz, never a money-disclosure prompt. The default frame is curiosity ("What did you notice about your customers this week?"), not interrogation ("How much did you make?").

"Money is a tool. The question is not whether your family has a lot of it. The question is what you do with the moves we are practicing — interview, math, message, listen — wherever your starting line happens to be."

— CASH

ACTIVITY INDEX

Ten Activities. One Notebook.

Every activity in this book is built to be done with a pencil, your own evidence, and the questions Cash keeps asking. Skip nothing. Date everything. Re-read in three months.

No.	Activity	What you will do
01	Day 1 Customer Assumption	One sentence, one card. Don't try to be right; try to be specific.
02	Open vs. Leading Questions	Rewrite five leading questions into open ones. Practice on a partner.
03	Coding Patterns from Transcripts	Highlight surprises, frustrations, wishes. Tally them. Find the pattern.
04	Persona Pack v1	Combine evidence into one specific person — name, behaviors, top frustration.
05	Variable Cost per Unit	From a real receipt, compute the cost per one of the thing you sell.
06	Contribution Margin Worksheet	Price minus variable cost. Decide if it covers your fixed costs.
07	Two-Message A/B Test	Two honest messages. Three-day test. Report the winner and why.
08	Persuasion vs. Manipulation Line	Sort 10 ad claims onto a line. Defend your placement.
09	1-Week Feedback Loop	Collect, code, and act on feedback. Document three changes.
10	Final Capstone Defense	Five slides. Five minutes. Show the moves you made.

NOTEBOOK SETUP

Get a single notebook for the whole year. Number every page. The first 5 pages are your Vocabulary Spine. The last 5 pages are your Day-1 Assumptions (you will come back to those). Everything in between is your work.

Notebook checklist

- **Title page** — your name, your venture working-title, today's date.
- **Vocabulary spine** — 5 pages reserved for definitions you will add as we go.
-

Customer notes — one section for interview transcripts. Use direct quotes, with initials and dates.

- **Math section** — receipts taped in, per-unit computations, contribution margin scratch work.
- **Messaging section** — drafts of two-claim A/B tests, with what won and why.
- **Feedback log** — one page per week of your feedback system, with the three changes you made.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Worked Example: Measure What Matters

Priya runs a tutoring micro-business helping 6th graders with pre-algebra. She has eight regular clients. Five say they would recommend her. Three would not. Her old metric was "hours billed." Her new metric: "would recommend."

The new metric tells a different story. Two of her three non-recommenders share the same complaint: "Sessions feel like quizzes." Priya redesigns the first 10 minutes of every session to start with what the student is stuck on, not what Priya wants to teach. Three weeks later: 7 of 8 would recommend.

What changed? Not effort. Not skill. The metric. "Would recommend" surfaced the experience. Hours billed surfaced nothing.

WHAT TO COPY

The move here is not the answer. It is the structure: specific number, specific person, specific decision. Use that pattern in your own venture this quarter.

> *"Most adults skip this. You won't. Pick one customer. Compute one number. Decide one thing." — Cash*

END-OF-QUARTER REFLECTION

Four Quarters. Same Five Questions.

At the end of every quarter you will answer the same five questions. The answers should look different over time. Reread the previous quarter before you write a new one.

1. **Which people did you talk to this quarter, and what did they actually say?**

   Specific quotes, initials, dates. Resist the urge to summarize.
2. **What did you change in your venture because of evidence?**

   Name the change. Name the evidence that caused it.
3. **What is one number you know better now than three months ago?**

   Variable cost per unit. Contribution margin. Anything quantitative.
4. **What is a claim you made that you would take back?**

   Be honest. The claim does not have to be public. The honesty is the move.
5. **What would Cash ask you about all of this?**

   "Which people, and how do you know?" is always available. Find your own version.

"Reflection is not a feeling check-in. It is a memory tool. The you in three months wants to know what the you today learned. Write it down so future-you can use it."

— CASH

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move through this program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepreneurship — no matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We promise clarity.

"A little less wrong, every week."

— CASH, GRADE 8